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UAE AIRLINES RESUME LIMITED DEPARTURES

Scheduled operations expected to remain closed until this afternoon

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE's General Civil Aviation Authority has announced the start of exceptional flight operations at airports across the country and major UAE airlines have begun limited repatriation and cargo flights.

In a statement, the Authority said it has "announced the commencement of exceptional flight operations at UAE airports, enabling stranded passengers affected by recent regional developments to depart, in line with the schedules to be announced by airlines to affected passengers and the relevant destinations."

It urged passengers not to go to airports unless they had been contacted by their airline.

"The Authority urges passengers whose flights have been impacted not to proceed to airports until they have been contacted and notified of their flight timings and details by their respective airlines, in order to avoid congestion and ensure smooth processing."

However, scheduled operations from UAE airports in Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah and Ras Al Khaimah will remain closed until today afternoon.

Dubai Airports confirmed a limited resumption of operations from yesterday. A small number of flights are operating from Dubai International (DXB) and Dubai World Central (DWC). Travellers have been told not to proceed to the airport unless contacted directly by their airline.

Emirates said it will operate a limited number of flights from the evening yesterday. Prior-



A huge crowd gathers to watch the fountain show at Burj Khalifa yesterday.
Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

ity is being given to customers with earlier bookings. Rebooked passengers will be contacted directly. All other flights remain suspended. City check-in points across Dubai are closed. flydubai has also resumed

select flights. Departures from Dubai include services to Moscow (Vnukovo), Kazan, Yekaterinburg and Novosibirsk. Returning flights include services from Hargeisa, Islamabad, Multan and Sialkot.

Etihaad confirmed that all scheduled commercial flights to and from Abu Dhabi remain cancelled. Some repositioning, cargo, and repatriation flights may operate with approvals in place.

According to flight tracking

DUBAI SAFER: MUSK

As regional tensions continue to weigh on the Gulf, a high-profile public exchange between two of the world's most prominent technology executives has drawn renewed attention to the UAE's safety profile with both defending Dubai as statistically safer than many European cities.

"Unfortunately, I had to leave Dubai for Europe — so I'm not only missing the free fireworks from Iran, but also exposing myself to greater risk. Given Europe's crime rates, Dubai is statistically safer even with missiles flying. Can't wait to be back." Pavel Durov, CEO of Telegram, posted on X. Tesla and SpaceX CEO Elon Musk was among those who responded to the post, echoing the sentiment. "No country is perfect, but Dubai and UAE broadly are objectively safer and better run than many areas of Europe," Musk said.

Strong defence

The UAE Ministry of Defence said yesterday that the country's air defence systems had successfully intercepted and destroyed nine ballistic missiles, six cruise missiles and 148 drones.

platform Flightradar24, Etihad operated flights to Amsterdam, London, Moscow, Mumbai, Delhi, Islamabad, Kochi, Bengaluru, Riyadh, Dammam, Jeddah, Muscat and Cairo.

SEE ALSO P3-11, 16, P-1



IFTAR 18:25

Fajr	05:23	Shuruq	06:36
Dhuhr	12:34	Asr	15:53
Maghrib	18:25	Isha	19:39

IMSAK 05:13

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



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Iran conflict expands as Gulf states warn of response

Hezbollah enters the fray; Gulf energy infrastructure comes under attack

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The war between Iran and US-Israeli forces expanded sharply yesterday, spreading across multiple fronts in the Middle East as Hezbollah entered the conflict, Gulf energy infrastructure came under attack and American warplanes were downed in a friendly fire incident over Kuwait.

Gulf states said they are ready to defend their territory and citizens after Iranian strikes targeted civilian and energy infrastructure, warning they would take all necessary measures to protect security and stability.

Qatar said that its air force on Sunday shot down two Iranian SU-24 aircraft.

Israeli airstrikes hit Beirut and Tehran, while Iran and allied armed groups launched



Smoke plumes billow following Israeli bombardment on Beirut's southern suburbs yesterday.

missiles and drones at Israel, US military installations and Gulf states. A Saudi oil refinery at Ras Tanura was partially shut down after a drone strike, tankers were attacked near the Strait of Hormuz and flights were disrupted across the region amid widening security concerns.

In Kuwait, three US F-15E fighter jets were mistakenly shot down during active combat involving Iranian aircraft, ballistic missiles and drones,

according to US Central Command. All crew members survived.

US officials said air superiority had been established over parts of Iran and operations would continue. Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth declined to rule out ground deployment and indicated the campaign could last several weeks. President Donald Trump said he envisages a four-week military operation.

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